

How to buy a laptop in India in 2025

Walk into any electronics store in Delhi or scroll Flipkart's Big Billion Days in 2025 and you'll see the same story: laptops aren't laptops anymore—they're AI-PCs, gaming rigs, creator studios, or cloud terminals disguised in 14-inch shells. What used to be a predictable market of "Intel inside" and "how much RAM can you afford" has fractured into a dozen new tribes, each with its own acronyms, chipsets, and promises of "future-proofing."

India is at the heart of this shift. According to IDC, shipments spiked in the first half of 2025 after two years of post-pandemic slump, with students and hybrid workers driving demand. At the same time, Counterpoint's research shows AI-ready laptops already account for nearly a third of premium notebook sales in India, largely fuelled by Qualcomm's Snapdragon X and AMD's Ryzen AI 300 series machines. The mid-tier still belongs to Intel Core Ultra, but even that landscape is changing as Lunar Lake chips roll out.

So what does this mean for you, the buyer? That choosing a laptop today isn't a single decision—it's a series of bets. You're betting on whether Microsoft's Copilot+ ecosystem becomes indispensable or fades. You're betting on whether an ARM-based Windows machine will run the quirky ERP software your business relies on. You're betting on whether OLED burn-in matters more than the buttery smoothness of a 240Hz mini-LED panel. And in India, you're betting on when to buy—festive sales, campus season, or a corporate refresh cycle can swing prices by tens of thousands of rupees.

That's where this Fast Track comes in. Over the next 32 pages, we'll cut through the noise with guided, actionable chapters designed for doers, not passive readers.

- Chapter 1 maps the landscape: what qualifies as a Copilot+ PC (hint: it's not every "AI-powered" machine), which chips meet Microsoft's bar of 40+ TOPS NPUs, and how to decode spec sheets that vendors deliberately muddy. We even build a flowchart to help you decide: buy now or wait.
- Chapter 2 strips spec obsession down to the eight things that actually matter—CPU/NPU, GPU, memory and storage, display, ports, connectivity, battery and thermals, plus webcams and build quality. Each gets a consumer-friendly teardown, complete with step-by-step tests you can do yourself in a showroom.
- Chapter 3 flips the script to use-case blueprints. Because a student in Pune doesn't need the same machine as a VFX freelancer in Mumbai, or a gamer in Bengaluru. Here, we anchor recommendations to Indian price bands, show you where to spend and where to save, and outline "Good/Better/Best" spec recipes that don't tie you to a single brand.
- Chapter 4 expands the field to platforms: x86 Windows, ARM Windows, macOS on Apple Silicon, Linux, and even ChromeOS Flex for resurrecting old hardware. For the first time, OS choice is as central as CPU choice, and we give you a step-by-step compatibility checklist so you know what will—and won't—run before you buy.
- Chapter 5 closes the loop with setup and longevity: a 60-minute day-one routine, myth-busting on battery care, real-world backup strategies, and upgrade paths so you can squeeze an extra three years out of your purchase.

Buying a laptop in 2025 is like buying a car in a city that's just adopted EVs: the old rules still apply, but new tech, new fuel, and new ecosystems are rewriting the road map. India's buyers are more discerning than ever—students care about GPU cores for AI projects, hybrid workers want Wi-Fi 7 for crowded flats, and creators won't settle for washed-out displays.

This Fast Track isn't here to add to the hype. It's here to hand you a field guide for navigating the most confusing laptop market in history, so you can walk into Croma or click "Buy Now" knowing exactly why that machine deserves a place in your backpack. 